

```

}

function smallerof(num1, num2){
    return num1 < num2 ? num1 : num2;
}

function averageof(num1, num2){
    return (num1 + num2) / 2;
}

```

Looks familiar? Even if it doesn't seem familiar, the syntax itself is quite apparent. You can declare variables using the keyword `var`, although it isn't necessary, and you can just write the variable name and equate it to its value.

Similar to most programming languages, JavaScript differentiates between equating and testing for equality. This means, if you need to assign the value 5 to a variable `num1`, you do the following:

```
num1 = 5;
```

However, if you need to check if the value of `num2` is 17 then:

```
num2 == 17;
```

Those familiar with programming will be wondering, what is the point of all of this if you are not outputting anything. Since JavaScript is used with HTML, there is no output in the traditional sense. What you will be doing instead, is writing this content to the page in some or the other element, or merely manipulating the layout as a result.

For those of familiar with C, Java or similar languages, you will notice the similar syntax, but for those of you who aren't, let's go through the basics of the language:

Performing arithmetic:

Operation	Description	Use
+	Addition	$z = x + y$
-	Subtraction	$z = x - y$
*	Multiplication	$z = x * y$
/	Division	$z = x / y$
%	Modulus i.e. Remainder	$z = x \% y$
++	Increment	$z++$
--	Decrement	$z--$